COUNTRY REPORTS: SEYCHELLES

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Status report

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

For a country ranked first in Africa for overall governance, at 75.3 out of 100 in 2023, Seychelles has remarkably little digital policy: no GovTech or digital transformation strategy, no whole-of-government approach to it, no ministry or department leading it, and no cross-government forum where senior digital officials meet (2025).

The institutions exist without the strategy to steer them. A government entity focused on GovTech, a coordination body and an entity monitoring digital spending across government are all in place, and none publishes an annual report on results or spending. There is no dedicated body or strategy for data governance either, no policy on where government cloud data may be hosted, no open source policy or action plan for the public sector and no national strategy on disruptive or innovative technologies, and interoperability is addressed only inside broader frameworks — Vision 2033, the ICT department's institutional strategic plan and the National ICT Policy — rather than by a strategy of its own.

What is committed on paper is sectoral and recent. Cabinet approved a National AI in Education Framework 2026-2030 on 22 July 2026 covering every state school, drafted with World Bank technical support. The national services portal egov.sc was relaunched in June 2026, jointly by the information and ICT departments. The Central Bank is retiring cheques on a dated four-stage timetable running to May 2026, and the Revenue Commission's mandatory e-invoicing procurement reached its final stage in July 2026. Cabinet approved a Digital Economic Transformation Forum on 9 September 2026 to agree a national digital architecture and pilots, and the President restated a target of fully digitalised e-government by 2030 in August 2026, naming technical assistance from Malta as the route.

Delivery is owned in pieces. The Minister for Finance chairs the Digital Economy Steering Committee and the ministry allocates the ICT budget, but holds no veto over technology spending in other departments, a power a World Bank review recommended and government did not take. The result reads clearly in what has been built: customs, tax, human resources, payroll, debt, treasury and social insurance systems are all in use, while there is no interoperability framework, no open data portal, no job portal, no participation platform and no feedback platform. Seychelles scored 0.6773 on the UN's 2024 E-Government Development Index, 92nd of the countries assessed.

Legislation and regulation

The statute meant to organise science and technology has not been switched on: the National Institute of Science, Technology and Innovation Act 2025, assented to on 22 December 2025, establishes NISTI as a body corporate to lead and coordinate science, technology and innovation research, but commences only on a date the Minister appoints, and no commencement date is on record, though the President described the institute in August 2026 as reinstated, with its secretariat under the Office of the Vice-President. Two Acts of 2026 are in force beside it: the

Seychelles Broadcasting Corporation Act, gazetted on 13 July, requires the broadcaster to keep a policy on its use of artificial intelligence, and the National Assembly Administration Act gives Parliament its own Office of Information Technology, Cybersecurity and Data Security.

The most worked-out rulebook is for payments. The National Payment System (Electronic Money) Regulations 2022, made by the Central Bank under section 42(1) of the National Payment System Act 2014, in force since 12 December 2022. They set an unimpaired initial capital floor of SCR 1,000,000, with ongoing capital the greater of that sum or 2% of the average outstanding float over the previous six months (2022); they require non-bank issuers to hold liquid assets matching the outstanding float, reconcile it to the Central Bank on the fifteenth day after each quarter, and spread safeguarded customer money across two or more banks or credit unions without co-mingling it with their own; and they place the receipt of funds against electronic money outside deposit-taking under the Financial Institutions Act, so an issuer needs no banking licence. Customer recourse sits in the Financial Consumer Protection Act of 2022 and its 2024 complaint-handling regulations.

Elsewhere the law reaches digital systems one at a time, not as a class: civil registration rests on the Civil Status Act, Cap 34, enacted in 1893 and consolidated as at 1 November 2022, the Road Transport (Amendment) Act 2023 created registers of driving licences and merit points, and SIM registration has been compulsory since December 2020.

The absences are telling. Seychelles imposes no data localisation requirement, on government data or anyone else's. Starlink began selling service under the existing telecommunications regulations, overseen by the Seychelles Communications Regulatory Authority, not by any new instrument. Two changes of July 2026 are Cabinet decisions rather than law: amendments to the Foreign Exchange Act 2009 widening the definition of authorised dealer to credit unions and licensed payment service providers, and the designation of the Financial Services Authority as supervisor of all public and private pension schemes.

Data protection

Every Seychelles controller and processor has been bound by the Data Protection Act 2023 in full since 22 June 2025, when the eighteen-month conformity window in section 56(1) closed and non-compliance became an offence.

The Act came into operation on 22 December 2023 and repealed the former Data Protection Act, a 2003 statute never implemented despite being one of the earliest attempts at such a law in Africa. Section 5 designates the Information Commission as supervisory authority, giving Seychelles a privacy regulator with enforcement powers for the first time, though the Commission was created under the Access to Information Act and designated afterwards rather than purpose-built. Controllers owe GDPR-aligned duties: explicit consent, impact assessments for high-risk processing, and a designated data protection officer for certain organisations, and the Act brings the first cross-border transfer regime and an expanded set of data subject rights the country has had. Processing for criminal investigation, national security and purely personal activity falls outside its scope.

Three holes sit in the drafting. A breach must be notified to the Commission within 72 hours and communicated to affected data subjects where required, but neither the length of any extension to that deadline nor the deadline for telling the data subjects is fixed. Section 23 treats anyone under 18 as a child and requires parental consent without naming any age-verification or consent-validation mechanism, and sensitive personal data may be processed on grounds of misconduct, a term the Act does not define.

Enforcement is provided for and invisible. The Commission may audit, investigate, impose penalties, seek injunctions and issue enforcement notices, and a person aggrieved by any of them may appeal to the Supreme Court within 21 working days, and its 2026-2028 strategic plan puts effective implementation and enforcement of both the

information and data protection Acts at the front of the next three years. What it produces is not visible: neither the authority's performance and results nor the complaints it receives are published (2025). Seychelles Commercial Bank confirmed a customer data breach in July 2025. And the July 2026 announcement that public CCTV cameras would be turned to automated vehicle identification named no legal basis, no retention rule and no role for the Commission.

Regional collaboration

The country's digital reach across its borders is mostly trade paperwork. The Revenue Commission launched a national electronic Certificate of Origin with the COMESA Secretariat on 4 July 2026 for trade facilitation and border security, and government is urging traders to use it to claim the reduced duties their trade agreements allow.

Money does not cross digitally. Seychelles appears nowhere in the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System's June 2026 coverage list, and its own domestic instant payment system is still in development, leaving no rail for a regional scheme to reach.

The broader integration position is stronger than the digital one. Seychelles scores 59.8 out of 100 for regional integration in 2023, 11th of 54 African states and up 7.6 points over the decade, and belongs to both COMESA and the Southern African Development Community. On data, the Information Commission places the country among the earliest signatories anywhere of the Council of Europe's convention on the automatic processing of personal data, in 1981. The NISTI Act's stated objectives include science diplomacy, alongside making research attractive to business and fostering innovation in schools, though no commencement date for the Act is on record.

Standards

Systems are built one at a time: Seychelles has no government interoperability framework, no data quality framework, no monitoring of the uptime of government information systems and no guidance for replacing legacy ones (2025). The ICT department's own account of its Policy, Standards and Research Section says it adopts technical standards for the interoperability of e-government services and the integration of every e-government application and database; no published framework is held.

Each system therefore arrives with its own conventions. SeyID integrates with the civil status identity database, the Licensing Authority and the monServis portal using OpenID Connect and OAuth; the electronic money regulations give interoperability a regulation of its own, defining it as one system working with others without any intervention by the customer; and the health ministry's own strategic plan records no formal standards and no coordination mechanisms for managing health data, with the electronic health information system begun in 2020 stalled.

Where a shared published standard is being adopted, it is one domain at a time. Cabinet endorsed the international S42 address standard for a national addressing and postcode system, and approved a National Addressing System Bill in April 2026 creating a National Addressing Department and a National Addressing Database Unit to govern it. A National AI in Education Steering Committee maintains lists of nationally approved and nationally prohibited AI tools for schools, and the framework reserves final grading, certification and student placement decisions to human judgement during its initial phases.

The quality half of the standards system has an institution behind it where the interoperability half does not. The Seychelles Bureau of Standards is constituted under Act 2 of 2014, whose thirty-six sections set the Board, the standards-making procedure, offences and penalties; a new eight-member Board was appointed for three years with effect from 1 August 2025, and the regional accreditation service's register shows the Bureau's mass-calibration capability approved on 15 September 2025 and valid to 14 September 2030. No count of national standards adopted, and no annual report of the Bureau, is held.

The gap shows most in procurement and in day-to-day operations. The e-procurement portal carries tender notices and contract awards but publishes none of it to the Open Contracting Data Standard, exchanges no data with other government systems, and has no governance arrangements covering its operation. Governance arrangements for the human resources and payroll systems exist but are internal and unpublished, while the customs, tax, financial management, treasury and e-procurement systems have none recorded at all.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Seychelles ranks first in Africa for deliberative and participatory governance, at 89.6 out of 100 in 2023 and up 27.7 points over the decade — and has no national platform through which a citizen or business can take part in a policy decision: no petitions, no anonymous feedback, no omnichannel access, and no publication of government responses (2025).

Nor is there a way to complain. No government platform takes feedback on service delivery, there is no support for users with disabilities on such channels, no published service standards such as response times, and no record of a service being changed in response to feedback. Citizens and businesses had no hand in designing the public service, tax and social insurance portals. The 2023-2025 Open Government Partnership action plan's commitment to an e-engagement portal has not begun.

Access to what government holds is the sharper constraint, and the regulator says so itself. The Information Commission's November 2025 whitepaper names the most urgent weakness of the Access to Information Act 2018 as the absence of any clear power to enforce its orders under section 63(1), with holders of information having ignored its directives since 2019 and no recourse available. The right-to-information law is in force and requires information to be made available digitally, yet no statistics on requests received or granted are published, and disclosure of public records has been static at 50.0 out of 100 since 2014.

Speech itself remains free and slightly less so than it was. Media freedom is among the ten most deteriorated of the country's governance measures, down 5.6 points over 2014-2023 to 79.3 out of 100, though still 3rd of 54, while freedom of expression and belief stands at 93.1, 2nd of 54 and up 16.7 points over the decade. Consultation happens where a ministry chooses it: the ICT department opened a public consultation on the draft data protection bill in August 2023, four months before the Act passed the National Assembly. A June 2026 amendment gave the President greater powers over appointing and dismissing the public broadcaster's board, and in a 2025 survey 45% said the media was somewhat or completely free against 52% who said it was not.

Finance

Financial sustainability

No digital project in Seychelles' 2026 budget is financed from abroad: the 2026 estimates' public investment programme carries SCR 18.7 million of foreign loans and SCR 339.8 million of foreign grants, none of it for a digital project (FY2026), and the Appropriation Act 2026 voted the ICT department SCR 93.8 million (2026).

The digital lines of the 2026 estimates come to SCR 239.6 million proposed, none of it externally financed, against SCR 276.2 million appropriated in 2025, of which 80.4% was the state's own (FY2026).

The external money of the two earlier years was not spent. The 2024 budget financed SCR 86.7 million of a new integrated financial management system with an Indian government loan, beside SCR 5.0 million of local money (FY2024); the 2025 budget put SCR 42.0 million of local money on it and no loan (FY2025), and the project spent nothing in 2024 and was revised to SCR 0.3 million for 2025 (FY2025). A SCR 54.3 million Chinese grant in kind for

the Revenue Commission's invoice management system sat in the 2025 budget (FY2025), the mid-year review cut the same sum from the Commission (2025), and the 2026 estimates give the Commission SCR 39.5 million for e-invoicing (FY2026).

The running costs sit on the ministries' own votes. The 2025 mid-year review gave the ICT department SCR 6.1 million for a Microsoft subscription and servers for the human resources system (2025), the 2026 estimates carry SCR 8.7 million for Autodesk licences for ministries (FY2026), the 2025 budget carried SCR 5.5 million for the health information system's annual maintenance contract (FY2025), and the biometric passport runs on a five-year maintenance contract with a French contractor of about US$153,000 a year (November 2024). The ICT department spent SCR 73.9 million of the SCR 78.9 million voted to it for 2024 (FY2024).

Own-source instruments are few. The Communications Act 2023 provides for a universal access and universal service fund fed by operator contributions, and the identity card is free on first issue, while replacing or amending one costs SCR 150 and an expatriate's card SCR 300 (2024).

MoUs and other agreements

Nothing signed for Seychelles' digital sector carries money with it. Hytera and Cable & Wireless Seychelles signed a memorandum of understanding at Mobile World Congress on 4 March 2025 to build a resilient, redundant emergency-communications network able to keep working through a disaster — a Chinese equipment maker and the country's dominant operator, on the network that would matter most in a cyclone. No value, no timetable and no build commitment attaches to it, and no deployment has followed.

The other undertaking on the record is India's Unified Payments Interface: Seychelles announced in June 2026 that it would bring the interface into service by the end of the year, with the Central Bank, local financial institutions and NPCI International implementing it — a target date rather than an obligation. Neither it nor the Hytera memorandum binds either side to spend, build or deliver, and the country's substantive digital commitments have come through loan agreements rather than through memoranda.

New investments

The World Bank has a dedicated digital project for Seychelles at concept stage: a US$25 million investment project, implemented by the ICT department, for inter-island fibre, shared digital-government infrastructure with AI-enabled services, and digital skills, with approval estimated for 17 December 2026. The Trade and Development Bank's USD 50 million facility to Cable & Wireless Seychelles was the largest single live commitment to the country's digital sector as at August 2026, and larger on its own than every public-sector commitment to Seychelles combined. That exposure began in 2019, when CWS Investment Ltd bought the incumbent operator from Liberty Latin America with a USD 70 million syndicated acquisition financing arranged by the bank, which lent USD 50 million of it alongside Absa Group and ABC Banking Corporation. In 2022 the bank refinanced the USD 48.1 million then outstanding with a USD 50 million package, including a USD 5 million convertible note and a term loan in Seychelles rupees.

The lender is a shareholder too: three months after CWS listed on the MERJ Exchange Seychelles, the bank took a stake of roughly 2.9 per cent (December 2022), and its note converts into further equity at a share listing.

Five commitments touching Seychelles' digital sector are on record, spread across 2019 to 2026 and worth about USD 164 million at face value, or nearer USD 114 million counting the 2022 refinancing once rather than twice. Connectivity takes most of it, both bank facilities having gone to the same operator; a social protection operation and a mixed-purpose budget-support loan, whose digital share is not stated, are the only public-sector commitments, and payments appear only as a sub-million venture round. None of it is grant money, and no bilateral donor and no Chinese, Gulf, Indian or EU institution is among the five.

Public money is thin. The World Bank's social protection Program-for-Results, whose digital component is the social protection registry and management information system, stands at a reported USD 30 million approved in March 2021 — approved, not disbursed. The African Development Bank approved a USD 34 million loan on 22 September 2026 for the third and final phase of its Economic Resilience and Green Recovery Support Programme, budget support whose named digital reforms are electronic invoicing for tax compliance, a national e-procurement system and a one-stop investment portal. Otherwise the state pays its own way: the finance ministry allocates the ICT budget, including SCR 145.1 million over the medium term for digital economy infrastructure in the 2023 budget, and the Ease of Doing Business portal went to a Norwegian registers developer at USD 1,295,452.86.

Private technology money barely registers: Fusepay raised a USD 350,000 pre-seed round backed by Hustle Fund and Everywhere Ventures (2025), the only venture round on record, and Seychelles is absent from Partech's 2025 tally of African tech venture funding.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Seychelles gained a second 5G network in July 2026, six years after its first. Cable & Wireless Seychelles launched the country's first 5G network with Huawei on 7 July 2020 and was operating public 4G and 5G as at March 2025. Airtel Seychelles switched on commercial 5G on 3 July 2026, having awarded Ericsson a turnkey contract in December 2021 to move its Seychelles network and core services into a new data centre and virtualise them in preparation for VoLTE and 5G. A third route opened the same month: Starlink began operating under a soft launch announced at State House on 21 July 2026, Cabinet having approved its licence in February 2026, and it sells direct to customers through its own platform rather than a local reseller. The incumbent has been Seychellois-owned since 2019, and access to any network runs through mandatory SIM registration against a national ID card or passport.

The wired estate under the mobile networks was built by the operators. Cable & Wireless completed a nationwide fibre-to-the-curb network in August 2012, fed by the 2,000 km SEAS cable to Dar es Salaam, which ended the country's reliance on satellite links; Airtel opened the first phase of its own fibre ring in May 2015; and 2Africa, brought ashore on 20 April 2023 by the private operator Intelvision with over 600 Gbps bought from Vodafone, became the third submarine cable to reach the islands.

Seychelles sits third of 54 African states for internet and computer access, at 79.4 out of 100 in 2023 after a 21.8-point rise over the decade, and yet only 35th of 54 for mobile communications, at 61.3 in 2023 — its weakest continental placing anywhere in the digital estate. 87.4% of individuals used the internet in 2023, and mobile subscriptions ran at around 126 per 100 people in 2024, down from a peak near 165 in 2019.

The domestic exchange layer is thin behind all this: the country has a single internet exchange point, SEY-IX, with few participants. Physical delivery is weaker still — Shipping & Postal Network is Seychelles' single worst Ibrahim Index indicator at 15.0 out of 100 in 2023, 41st of 54, and its most deteriorated measure of the decade at 16.8 points down since 2014, which is what an island economy's e-commerce depends on. Taken together the aggregate has hardly moved: infrastructure scored 67.0 in 2023, up 1.1 points over 2014-2023 against a national average gain of 10.0.

Data Storage

Nothing keeps Seychelles government data in Seychelles. No policy governs where government cloud data may be hosted, and the state monitors and publishes nothing on government cloud usage, security or savings (2025), and no data localisation requirement applies to anyone, government included (2024). Nor is there anywhere obvious to put it domestically: no shared cloud platform is available to government entities, with no platform type, no cloud services and no answer recorded on whether one exists at all (2025).

What capacity exists is commercial. Airtel Seychelles' data centre holds TIA-942 Rated-3 certification, the first such certification in the country (2022), and it is the facility Airtel moved its national network core into under the 2021 Ericsson contract. Cable & Wireless Seychelles inaugurated the Bon Espoir data centre in November 2024, and the Uptime Institute awarded it Tier IV design and construction certification on 4 September 2025. There is no in-country hyperscale cloud region, the nearest AWS and Azure regions being in South Africa. Government hosting sits with the department itself: the Department of Information Communications Technology operates the government-wide Electronic Government Network, with a network operations section and server-room infrastructure connecting ministries, inspected by a National Assembly committee in June 2025.

Energy

The grid reaches everyone and burns imported fuel to do it. Renewables supplied around 5% of electricity generation in 2023, with over 95% still coming from imported fossil fuels, against a national target of 15% by 2030 and a newly launched Renewable Energy Acceleration Programme. Access itself is settled: 100% of the population had electricity in both urban and rural areas in 2023, which places Seychelles first of 54 African states on access to energy, at a perfect 100.0 and unchanged over 2014-2023. There is no electrification gap for a digital economy to fall into.

Supply is not seamless. Firms reported around half an electrical outage a month, roughly six a year, in the 2023 World Bank Enterprise Survey — enough to matter for anything run without a generator or a battery. Residential electricity costs roughly SCR 2 per kWh, about US$0.15 (2024). The route out of the fuel bill is being opened to private supply: the Electricity Act 2023 and the Electricity (Distributed Generation System) Regulations 2024 establish net metering, net billing and feed-in-tariff arrangements administered by the Public Utilities Corporation and the Utilities Regulatory Commission, alongside utility-scale projects including the 5 MWp Ile de Romainville solar farm and the Port Victoria wind farm.

Technical Capacity

Public administration is Seychelles' worst continental placing of any Ibrahim Index sub-category: 10th of 54 at 64.4 out of 100 in 2023, up only 4.5 points over the decade, in a country that ranks first or third on most of what it is measured on. Statistical capacity has moved the other way over the same decade.

The state builds little of its own core. The national digital ID runs on a Swiss vendor's proprietary platform, though a World Bank assessment credits the Department of Information Communications Technology with a solid foundation of in-house technical capacity, and the department shared delivery of the relaunched egov.sc portal in June 2026. The pipeline behind those teams is narrow. Only one tertiary provider offers ICT and computing programmes, the University of Seychelles, delivering its IT and computer science degrees through a partnership with a Malaysian university; there is no government strategy or programme to improve digital skills in the public sector, and nothing published on results (2025); and the country's own 2023-2025 Open Government Partnership action plan records a long-standing shortage of AI and cybersecurity expertise across both the public and private sectors.

Cybersecurity

Seychelles Commercial Bank confirmed a customer data breach after an attacker penetrated its network on 5 February 2025 and exfiltrated roughly 2.2 GB of records on 3-4 July 2025 — names, dates of birth, phone numbers, addresses, emails, account types and balances. Five months passed between entry and exfiltration. The bank suspended internet banking, apologised to customers and engaged the police.

Seychelles scored 50.41 out of 100 on the ITU's 2024 Global Cybersecurity Index, ranking 132nd and placing it in the establishing tier. Coordination runs through the National Cybersecurity Coordination Committee and a Cyber Secretariat, both approved by Cabinet on 10 July 2024, whose visible activity in the period was a May 2025

workshop with media practitioners on artificial intelligence, ethics and cybersecurity. Reporting duties are on the statute book: controllers must notify the Information Commission of a personal data breach within 72 hours of becoming aware of it. The ICT department launched CERT-SC, the national computer emergency response team, in July 2025, on a recommendation of the 2024 cybersecurity maturity assessment supported by the World Bank. The response team designed and delivered the third national cyberdrill itself in October 2026, for the first time, and the National Assembly approved accession to the Budapest Convention on Cybercrime in July 2026, the accession itself still to follow.

Defence of the state's own estate is patchier than the law implies. Operational governance — registers, security and audit trails — is recorded for the human resources and payroll systems but held internally and unpublished, and is recorded not at all for the customs, tax, financial management, treasury and e-procurement systems (2025), and the World Bank's digital government assessment flagged thin security investment, particularly in regular penetration testing, as a threat to all government ICT systems. Resilience is being addressed through the incumbent rather than the state: a March 2025 memorandum between Cable & Wireless Seychelles and China's Hytera envisages a redundant emergency-communications network, planned as mission-critical push-to-talk cores integrating with the operator's public 4G and 5G networks for public safety, energy, transport and tourism users.

DPI

Data Exchange

Seychelles moves data between government systems without anything governing how it is done: as at 2025 there was no government interoperability framework, no data quality framework and no guidance for replacing legacy systems, and nothing is monitored or published about the use, compliance or benefits of the sharing arrangements that do exist. Exchange happens anyway, system by system: the tax, customs, human resources and social insurance systems all exchange data with other parts of government, while the financial management system, still being implemented, exchanges none (2025).

The most substantial attempt to join the registers together was tendered in November 2024, a Land Management Administration Information System designed to interface the land register with the National Population Database, the SeyID identity platform, the Immigration Information System and public financial management, and still under development. Narrower links already carry traffic. The Revenue Commission's customs payment facility runs as a module of the ASYCUDA customs system (June 2024). The Seychelles Electronic Border System, live since November 2022, feeds embarkation, disembarkation and advance passenger data in real time into immigration databases. The Agency for Social Protection was synchronising benefit-payment data with the Seychelles Pension Fund by May 2025 as it builds a multi-agency social registry. And a national electronic Certificate of Origin was launched with the COMESA Secretariat on 4 July 2026.

The unbuilt half is the more telling one. A 2024 assessment of the e-Services Gateway and SeyGo Connect found the country's several digital government initiatives showed little evidence of talking to each other. A Health Information Exchange Maturity Assessment was held in July 2025 with Africa CDC support, the exchange itself still being matured rather than deployed. An October 2023 national digital health maturity assessment scored standards and interoperability at 2, against a global average of 3, and Africa CDC called for consultants in September 2026 to draft a national interoperability framework for health information exchange.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Since 17 September 2024 no new work-permit holder in Seychelles has been given a physical identity card: non-citizens on permits are registered on SeyID and issued a virtual card valid for the duration of the permit, while Seychellois citizens keep the option of a physical card, which expires every ten years. The digital-only credential is compulsory for foreigners, voluntary for nationals.

The identity beneath the app is older than it. The National Population Database was established digitally in 1988, is updated daily from civil status registrations, and the National Identity Number it assigns has been compulsory by law since 1995. Holding a valid card is mandatory for every resident, and foreign nationals over 16 on work permits must enrol too, and the World Bank describes a comprehensive identity database whose cards are widely held. First issuance is free and SeyID registration carries no fee (2024), and citizens living abroad can enrol with an identity card or ID letter and a passport.

SeyID launched in November 2022 and was delivered and operational by April 2024, built by the Swiss company WISeKey on its WISeID platform under a partnership the government entered in 2014 — a national credential resting on a foreign vendor's proprietary product. What it reaches is real but bounded. It is the mandatory authentication for the monServis portal, where business and vehicle licences are transacted; a certificate ordered through CertExpress is saved to the holder's E-Doc wallet; its QR code supports remote verification for opening a bank account, though a physical card or passport remains an accepted alternative there; and the National Identity Number is used across the social programmes run by the Agency for Social Protection.

SeyID operates under the Civil Status Act, which governs the number, and the Data Protection Act 2023, which governs the data. Registered users can see what is held about them, and the platform publishes which fields it collects and the consent mechanism by which they reach integrated third parties. The e-passport introduced in November 2022 embeds the holder's facial image and fingerprints, and SeyID's onboarding captures a live facial video.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Seychelles is legislating the cheque out of existence without an instant payment rail to put in its place. The Revenue Commission imposed limits on cheque payments for taxes, duties and levies from 13 July 2026, and plans to stop accepting them entirely by the end of 2028, and the Central Bank has been withdrawing cheques in stages since the start of 2025, from individuals first and non-residents during 2026. Yet Seychelles sits on the regional list of countries where a domestic instant payment system is still in development (2024).

What does run is SEFT, the domestic electronic funds transfer system the Central Bank operates, which with card payments carried over 10 million transactions in 2023 against around 600,000 cheques. The Central Bank both operates that core infrastructure and licenses and supervises the other payment service providers. Seychelles appears nowhere in the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System's coverage (June 2026). Seychelles announced in June 2026 that it would bring India's Unified Payments Interface into service by the end of the year.

The rulebook is public and unusually complete for the market's size. The National Payment System Act 2014 and its licensing and electronic money regulations set out access, technical, conduct and complaint rules. The 2022 electronic money regulations give interoperability its own provision, defining it as one system working with another without any intervention from the customer, allow issuers to distribute airtime and data while barring airtime itself from being used to pay for anything. Complaint-handling units became compulsory for financial services providers, payment providers included, under regulations made in 2024. The Central Bank opened a public consultation in March 2026 on regulations for a sandbox in which new financial products, digital payments among them, can be tested under supervision.

Pensions, disability benefits and welfare assistance go straight into beneficiaries' bank accounts, a World Bank-financed reform having required every beneficiary to hold one (2025), but access to banking services scores 48.8 out of 100 on the Ibrahim Index for 2023, up only 4.5 points across the decade. Fusepay made its first live transaction in Victoria on 19 November 2025, selling virtual business accounts and post-dated digital payments to replace the cheque.

Registries

Seychelles has no working national address register, and it shows in every register that would use one: neither the land register nor the business register can be tied to one, and a company's address is captured only as free text (2026). Cabinet approved a National Addressing System Bill in April 2026, creating a National Addressing Department and a National Addressing Database Unit, on the international S42 address standard it had already endorsed.

The population register is the strong one. The National Population Database, held by the Civil Status Division, consolidates birth, marriage, death and identity records for the whole resident population and UNHCR records the country as having achieved universal birth registration. Capture is still a counter transaction: a birth must be registered in person within 30 days at one of three civil status offices, on production of a maternity certificate, though since May 2023 maternity wards have notified Civil Status of each birth electronically within three days, and doctors of each death within 24 hours, so that a child whose parents do not come forward is registered provisionally. Civil registration is among Seychelles' ten worst-scoring Ibrahim Index indicators, at 50.0 out of 100 in 2023 and unmoved since 2014.

The other registers are digital in retrieval and manual in transaction. The business register offers online search and online registration, the Revenue Commission runs online Tax Identification Number registration for individuals and businesses, and that registration requires a validated National Identity Number, and for a company the Registrar's certificate, tying the tax register to both. The land register runs an eSearch platform covering title deeds, charges, transfers and leases, but access requires an in-person subscription at the Office of the Registrar General and registration transactions remain substantially manual (2025), while a cadastral WebGIS viewer has given public search of parcels and planning layers since November 2013. The Road Transport (Amendment) Act 2023 created registers of driving licences and merit points, with courts required to notify the Licensing Authority of traffic convictions.

The Electoral Commission's digital voters' register, certified for 2025, can be checked online or by SMS against a National Identity Number, and deceased persons reach it as a monthly feed from Immigration and Civil Status, though changes take effect only at annual or pre-election certification and registration cannot be done online.

Sectoral management information systems

Seychelles has built the government's back office and not its front door: customs, tax, human resources, payroll, debt, treasury and social insurance systems are all in use, while there is no interoperability framework, no digital transformation strategy, no open data portal, no job portal and no participation or feedback platform (2025).

Customs and debt run on commercial packages, tax, human resources, payroll and social insurance on custom software; payroll is linked to the human resources system, which offers no self-service portal; and public-sector employees sit in a separate social insurance scheme. The integrated financial management system is still being implemented, covers central government budgets only, captures spending against strategic goals only partially and captures no non-financial performance indicators at all — it can report what spending cost, not what it achieved. The

finance ministry signed the development contract in early 2025 with Linpico in joint venture with PFM Smart System, for completion by early 2026, to replace accounting software that needed numerous manual interventions (2024). There is no public investment management system.

Health and education are the laggards. Health data capture is primarily paper-based on a variety of duplicative reporting tools, and the electronic Health Information System begun in 2020 stalled and needs renewed effort. The Education Management Information System produces school-level enrolment and statistics with no link to civil registration, digital identity or social protection, an African Union mission in 2019 found school data collection inconsistent, its methods unreliable and transmission slow, and the ministry has joined the OpenEMIS community and is in training ahead of a nationwide rollout of digital school-level capture.

The Attorney General's Electronic Case Management System went live on 23 June 2026 with shared calendars, virtual-meeting links, case-data retrieval and secure chat, and nothing that reaches another register. The Judiciary launched an e-Service platform on 26 November 2025 on which legal practitioners file written submissions and pay fees by card, a first phase before public access, under rules the Chief Justice made in September 2025 for electronic filing in civil matters before the Supreme Court. The Agency for Social Protection launched ASP Connect internally on 15 October 2025 to manage benefit applications and payments. Police case management is deployed across the country's police stations, with search across districts. The Ministry of Employment's Labour Market Information System registers vacancies, jobseekers, placements and redundancies, and a second phase has been tendered to interface with the population database, SeyID, immigration and finance ministry payments. The lands department tendered in January 2025 for a land valuation system to interface with the population database, SeyID and the financial management system, and no award is on record.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Seychelles relaunched its national services portal in June 2026, egov.sc having gone more than a decade without meaningful review and worked as little more than an email gateway for public servants. Vice-President and ICT Minister Sébastien Pillay launched the replacement under the tagline "Access Government Services, With Just One Click".

What a citizen or business can do is real but narrow. The public service portal reaches transactional maturity, so users complete transactions rather than only downloading forms (2025). SeyID is the mandatory login for monServis, where business licences, vehicle licences and other services are transacted, CertExpress has issued birth, marriage and death certificates online since September 2024 without a visit to a civil status office, and customs charges have been payable online since June 2024. But a resident cannot start a business or establish an e-residency through the portal, no government mobile app for public services has been released, and nothing is published on how online services perform. Tax shows the pattern plainly: returns are lodged by email and paid by bank transfer, and the paper assessment letter gave way to a digital acknowledgment notice only in April 2026.

An e-procurement portal carries tender notices and contract awards, but publishes nothing to the Open Contracting Data Standard and exchanges data with no other government system. A government entity for GovTech and digital transformation exists, with a coordination body and an entity monitoring digital spending across government, none of which publishes an annual report of its results or spending. Seychelles scored 0.6773 on the UN's 2024 E-Government Development Index, 92nd of the states assessed. An Ease of Doing Business one-stop portal was announced in November 2025 by the Ministry of Investment, Entrepreneurship and Industry, bringing services, document submission and payment together.

An eight-week pilot announced in July 2026 will turn existing public CCTV cameras at Roche Caïman on Mahé into automated traffic enforcement: the cameras identify the vehicle's make and read its number plate, and an officer issues an electronic ticket delivered by message, targeting speeding, phone use at the wheel and seatbelt non-compliance, with permanent adoption envisaged in partnership with the Australian firm Acusensus.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

There is no sub-national tier of government to digitalise: the 26 administrative districts sit below a single national layer, so all digital government services operate nationally (2024). The nearest thing to district-level digital administration is a national service reaching outward — a police case-management application deployed across police stations and searchable across districts (2025) — rather than a system any district owns or runs.

Rural digital data capture

Registering a birth still means attending a counter in person: civil registration is conducted at one of three Civil Status offices, at Victoria, Grand Anse Praslin and La Digue, within 30 days of the birth and on production of a maternity certificate and identity documents at the desk, with no remote or online channel for the registration event itself (2024). The state's front office reaches each of the three populated islands, and the event is declared in person at the desk. Health is the same picture from the ministry's own account: data capture is primarily paper-based, spread across a variety of duplicative reporting tools, and the electronic Health Information System begun in 2020 stalled and requires renewed effort, in the National Health Strategic Plan 2022-2026. In education, a 2019 pilot of the African Union's DataPlat platform was introduced to address school data collection that was inconsistent, unreliable and slow to transmit (2019).

The agricultural sector is small and barely measured: agriculture earns 2.48% of GDP (2021), and no agricultural survey has been held in the past ten years (2023). The rural economy goes largely unmeasured as well: Seychelles has no data at all for 21 of the Ibrahim Index's 96 indicators, including every indicator in its Rural Economy sub-category, against improvement in 56 and decline in 11 over the decade to 2023.

What reaches beyond Mahé is infrastructure rather than data capture. Electricity access is universal, at 100% of the population in urban and rural areas alike (2023), and 57.1% of the population lives in urban areas, above the regional average (2021). Among operational systems, the police case-management application connects every station in the country (2025).

Technology

AI

Cabinet approved a National AI in Education Framework 2026-2030 on 22 July 2026, covering every state school in the country, a framework drafted with technical support from the World Bank. It is approved policy rather than practice. The framework is governed by a national steering committee that maintains lists of approved and prohibited tools for schools, it reserves grading, certification and placement decisions to human judgement in its early phases, and it rests on teacher capacity rather than a new subject, each of which is a duty the education system now owes rather than a change already made in a classroom.

The one statutory AI obligation on record falls on the public broadcaster: the Seychelles Broadcasting Corporation Act 2026 requires it to develop and review a policy on the use of AI in content and broadcast operations. The science and innovation statute stops at promotion. The NISTI Act 2025 sets the institute an objective of devising strategies to promote artificial intelligence, other emerging technologies and digitisation across the country's socio-economic development, which is a promotional purpose rather than a rulebook or a regulator.

Inside government, nothing is running. A shortage of artificial-intelligence and cybersecurity expertise across the public and private sectors has left digital projects unimplemented and unmaintained for a decade (2023), and no chatbot or AI-enabled forum supports citizen engagement (2025). The nearest thing to an operating system is enforcement rather than administration: a pilot announced in July 2026 that would read offending vehicles' plates off the public CCTV cameras already installed and route an electronic ticket to the driver. Tourism is the exception the minister named: an AI travel assistant has run on the official destination website for two years, and a forum on 1 October 2026 is to feed a Tourism Digital and AI Agenda.

The working deployments are commercial. Fusepay released Fuse360 in July 2026, a trade-business operating platform whose AI agents automate reconciliation, collections, reporting and credit monitoring alongside business and customer onboarding checks. Beyond that, public engagement with what AI does to institutions has been episodic: the national cybersecurity centre and the media practitioners' association ran a World Press Freedom Day workshop on AI's impact on press freedom, ethics and cybersecurity in May 2025.

ICT Industry

Seychelles' public digital systems run on software bought abroad, and no instrument exists to change that. The national digital ID was built by a Swiss vendor on its own proprietary identity platform, and the ease-of-doing-business portal project launched in November 2025 with a foreign supplier, targeted for full service by 30 June 2026. Against that, there is no government policy to support technology startups and private investment in them, no government financing to startups or SMEs for innovation, no procurement policy that prioritises their bids, and nothing published on support given to them (2025). Procurement is the point that bites: a state that buys its systems from outside and gives its own suppliers no preference in doing so is choosing, by default, not to have a domestic industry. A Seed Capital Grant Scheme does run: Cabinet approved revisions to it on 13 May 2026, redefining the youth beneficiary and revising eligibility.

The market a domestic sector would sell into is also thin on the government side. Residents cannot start a business or establish an e-residency through the public service portal, no government mobile app exists for citizen access to services, and no performance or user-experience data on online delivery is published (2025) — and where the state does not publish how its own services perform, there is little for a local supplier to bid against.

The wider business environment is stronger than the sector it houses. Business and Labour Environment is the country's worst-scoring Ibrahim Index sub-category at 58.7 out of 100 in 2023, even as it ranks 4th of 54 countries and has improved 14.4 points over the decade, with business and competition regulations the weakest component at 55.6 and 26th of 54. Firm-level conditions are similarly untroubled by African norms: firms reported around half an electrical outage a month in 2023. What is missing is not the operating conditions but the firms — Partech's tracker recorded no venture funding to Seychelles-based startups in 2025.

Innovation ecosystem

The law that would give Seychelles an innovation institution has been passed and not switched on: the National Institute of Science, Technology and Innovation Act 2025 commences only on a date the Minister appoints, and no commencement date is on record. What waits behind that commencement is substantial. NISTI's statutory functions include running a Science Academy and establishing incubation centres, science parks and maker-spaces, and its

objectives extend to science diplomacy, making research and development attractive to business, and fostering innovation in schools alongside the research coordination mandate that is the Act's main purpose. The President described the institute in August 2026 as reinstated as the implementation arm for science and innovation policy, with a near-term focus on digitalising public-service delivery.

Until it commences, the standing infrastructure is small and predates it. A government-backed Business and Technology Incubator has run under the Division of Science, Technology and Innovation since 2019, and the University of Seychelles established a Centre for Innovation in 2025. Inside government there is no matching capability: no entity or innovation lab focused on public sector innovation, no operating programme, no collaboration with the private sector on it and no published results (2025), and no open source policy or action plan for the public sector and no national strategy on disruptive or innovative technologies (2025). The state, in other words, neither makes new things nor has a route to buy them. Ground was broken on 21 July 2026 on a regional incubation and innovation hub at Ile Perseverance, expected to operate in 2027.

The country placed 75th on WIPO's 2025 Global Innovation Index. Firm-level innovation is a single case rather than a pipeline: Fusepay, founded in Seychelles, took its first live business payment in Victoria in November 2025 on the back of a small pre-seed round from foreign funds, and extended into an AI-driven operating platform for trade businesses in July 2026. It is also the exception that measures the rule: Partech recorded no venture funding to Seychelles-based startups in 2025.

Capacity

Literacy

Seychelles ranked first of 54 African states for both equality in education and education quality in 2023, and tenth for the human resources its education system commands, a measure that had risen by 10.7 points over the preceding decade. On the continent's education indicators there is almost nowhere further for the country to go.

The exception is enrolment, the weakest part of the record at ninth of 54 in 2023, where the gain over 2014-2023 was 5.5 points. Ninth of 54 is a strong showing in its own right; it is the one education measure on which the country does not lead the continent.

What the schooling record does not settle is whether people can read the systems government is building. The country's answer, approved in July 2026, is to teach machine literacy through the subjects that already exist: the National AI in Education Framework declines to create a standalone AI subject, requiring instead that AI literacy be carried across the whole curriculum, in every state school in the country. It is a design decision with consequences for teacher capacity rather than for timetables, and it is examined below.

For adults outside the school system the commitments are thinner. The 2023-2025 Open Government Partnership action plan undertakes to raise IT literacy, including among the elderly, and to leave no one behind in digital engagement, while recording that its own e-engagement portal commitment had not begun. Against that, government offered no digital skills programmes to citizens or schools as at 2025. A Digital School Initiative launched with the United Arab Emirates puts technology into classrooms, which is not the same thing as teaching the population to use the state's own services.

Training and skills

Every teacher in Seychelles is to hold an AI micro-credential, and every school to name an AI Champion, under a four-level National Teacher AI Competency Framework that is the central mechanism of the country's AI in education policy. Mandatory credentialling of an entire teaching workforce is an unusually direct instrument, and it is the largest training commitment the state has made in this area.

It sits against an otherwise empty field. As at 2025, Seychelles had no government strategy or programme to improve digital skills in the public sector, no digital skills programmes offered by government to citizens or schools, and published nothing on digital skills results or progress. Nor is there any machinery connecting skills to work: the country runs no government job portal, so public-sector vacancies are not published on one and jobseekers are offered no online job-matching. Whatever skills the education system produces, the state does not run the channel that would route them into work. One programme has since begun through a partner: a memorandum with India's National Centre for Good Governance commits to training 250 civil servants over three years, and a first cohort of 29 completed a two-week programme covering digital public infrastructure and AI-enabled governance on 22 May 2026.

At tertiary level the pipeline narrows to one point. Only one provider in the country offers ICT and computing programmes: the University of Seychelles, which delivers its IT and Computer Science degrees through an academic partnership with Malaysia's SEGi University. The domestic supply of technical graduates therefore depends on one institution and on a curriculum awarded through a foreign partner, which is the upstream half of the vendor dependence the infrastructure chapter records.

Around that sit a small network of technology and innovation hubs, including a government-backed incubator running under the Division of Science, Technology and Innovation and a university innovation centre opened in 2025, and a vendor-supplied smart classroom deployment in four secondary schools from August 2025. Both put equipment and space in front of people; neither is a training programme.

Research institutions

Seychelles gave itself a statutory research body in December 2025. The National Institute of Science, Technology and Innovation Act, assented to on 22 December 2025, establishes NISTI as a body corporate to lead and coordinate science, technology and innovation research in the country, giving research a single national institution with legal personality of its own.

The Act's list of functions is the more revealing document. NISTI is charged with establishing a digital repository of scientific data held on open access, which would make the country's research output readable rather than merely produced, and with running a Science Academy and establishing incubation centres, science parks and maker-spaces. Its stated objectives reach further still, to science diplomacy, making research and development attractive to business, and fostering innovation in schools. These are powers conferred on paper in the last month of 2025, and the repository, the academy and the parks are things the statute permits rather than things standing.

On output, Seychelles ranked 75th of the economies covered by WIPO's 2025 Global Innovation Index, a position it holds with the institutional architecture above still being assembled.

The research base under all of this is narrow. Knowledge production in computing runs through the single tertiary provider offering ICT and computing programmes, and the state's own capacity to evaluate what it does is limited by a financial management system that captures no non-financial performance indicators on programmes and projects — so the evidence a domestic research community would work from is not being generated by government spending itself.

Inclusion

Access to services

Seychelles ranks first of 54 African states for equal access to public services, scoring 94.5 out of 100 and up 10.3 points over the decade (2023). What limits reach is specific rather than general. The public consultation on withdrawing cheques raised financial-exclusion concerns for the groups that still rely on them, and the cost to those groups of taking up digital alternatives (September 2024). Citizens have not had the paper route taken away from them — a physical identity card remains an option, and SeyID is accepted but not required for banking. Against that, the state runs no platform on which a person can complain about a service, ask for information or be supported through a disability and no citizen-facing mobile app (2025), so the portal on which transactions with the state can be completed is reachable by browser and by nothing else, with no route back for the person it fails. Feedback is taken ministry by ministry instead: the finance ministry has received complaints and compliments through an online form routed to a single email address since April 2023, requiring a national identity number. Protection against discrimination remains one of the country's weakest-scoring governance indicators despite a large gain over the decade (2023).

The newest access route is bought outside the country entirely: Starlink subscriptions are taken through Starlink's own online platform rather than a local reseller, and officials confirmed that a number of people in Seychelles had already acquired kits and were using the service (22 July 2026). The receiver must be sited with a clear, unobstructed view of the sky, officials naming trees and buildings as obstructions that degrade the service — a condition that bears on who can use it in a country of steep, wooded granitic islands.

Digital divides

The gap the Seychellois government names in its own plans is age rather than income: the 2023-2025 Open Government Partnership action plan commits to raising IT literacy among the elderly and to leaving no one behind in digital engagement, while recording the commitment to an e-engagement portal as not begun (2024).

The divides that shape the rest of the continent sit differently here. Seychelles has Africa's highest GDP per capita, at USD 17,879, and its smallest population, around 0.1 million (2023), and 57.1% of that population lives in urban areas (2021) rather than dispersed across a large rural interior. Its showing on internet access and computer use is among the strongest on the continent and rose faster over the decade than any other part of its infrastructure, and there is no electrification gap left to close. Age, disability and the habits of people who have not moved off paper are what the inclusion question turns on.

Data

National statistics

Seychelles' statistical system ranks near the top of the continent and still cannot answer basic questions about its own economy: its Capacity of the Statistical System score rose 14.8 points over 2014-2023 to 71.1 out of 100, 6th of 54 African states, while the World Bank records no agricultural, business or health survey held in the past ten years, against three or more labour force surveys and two household surveys in the same period. An IMF mission in April 2024 was the first government finance statistics assistance since 2011, sent to revive compilation after disruption from Covid-19 and high staff turnover. The first national strategy for the development of statistics, for 2023 to 2027, had its mid-term evaluation in February 2026.

The census record runs the same way. A population census has been held within the past ten years and an agricultural census within the past twenty, but no business census in twenty years. Of the five pillars the World Bank scores, the weakest is data services, in the 20-49% band in 2023, where data use scores above 89%, data infrastructure between 70 and 89%, and data products and data sources both between 50 and 69% — a system that holds and uses data better than it releases it.

The gaps show up in what outside bodies can measure: 21 of the Ibrahim Index's 96 indicators carry no data at all for Seychelles, including every indicator in the Rural Economy sub-category, against 56 that improved over 2014-2023 and 11 that declined. Public administration is among the country's weakest Ibrahim sub-categories.

Administrative sources are filling the survey gap one sector at a time rather than through a common platform. The Bureau of Statistics takes restricted feeds from line agencies, among them the Fisheries Information Management System the Fishing Authority launched in 2023, and is working with the Ministry of Employment and the ILO to centralise labour market statistics; a second phase of the employment ministry's system has been tendered to interface directly with the population database and other registers. The registers beneath are the strong part, with civil registration consolidated into a single national population database. Health is the weak one: the ministry's own strategic plan records data capture as primarily paper-based, using a variety of duplicative reporting tools, with an electronic health information system that stalled after 2020.

Open data

Seychelles' information regulator says its own orders cannot be enforced: the Information Commission's November 2025 whitepaper names the absence of any clear power to enforce orders under section 63(1) of the Access to Information Act 2018 as the law's most urgent weakness, with holders of information having ignored its directives since 2019 and no recourse available.

The right itself is in force and effective, requiring information to be made available to the public online or digitally, with a body monitoring compliance — though no statistics on requests received or granted are published. The two Ibrahim measures of records access point in opposite directions: accessibility of public records is one of the ten most improved measures, up 26.0 points over 2014-2023, yet scores only 46.3 out of 100 in 2023 at 11th of 54, while disclosure of public records has been static at 50.0 out of 100 since 2014, 9th of 54, among Seychelles' ten worst-scoring indicators.

Nothing collects the material in one place. There is no open data portal, so no central point publishes government data in reusable form, and no government entity in charge of data governance, no strategy or policy for it, and no progress or spending report. All sixteen transparency and publication indicators assessed in the 2025 GovTech Maturity Index return a negative, covering cloud use, interoperability, data protection, right-to-information requests, digital skills, public investment and online service delivery.

What does get published is skewed to money. Open Data Watch's 2024 inventory puts balance of payments, international trade, and money and banking at 6.5 out of ten each as the strongest categories, crime and justice at 2.5, and education facilities, education outcomes, health facilities and poverty each at 3.0, and telecommunications and digital data, food security and nutrition, and health outcomes at zero out of ten.

Two openings exist on paper. Statute places a digital repository of scientific data held on open access among the new science and innovation institute's functions, and the Information Commission has recommended reforming the 2018 Act, including open-reuse licensing and a centralised access-to-information unit. Seychelles publishes Open Government Partnership action plans.

One sectoral system does publish. The fisheries ministry describes an operating Fisheries Information Management System giving public access to fisheries statistics, licensing and export data (June 2026) — the clearest working open-data service on record, and it belongs to one ministry rather than to the state. The instrument that would generalise it has been owed for six years: the extractives transparency board found in September 2020 that revenue data was published in open format but that the multi-stakeholder group did not appear to have an open data policy, and set a corrective-action deadline to publish one. Nothing held records that policy being made.

Use of satellite data

Satellite reached Seychelles in 2026 as bandwidth rather than imagery: Starlink service began under a soft launch announced at State House on 21 July 2026, with the Communications Regulatory Authority presenting the regulatory framework alongside Vice-President Sebastien Pillay, with a formal launch ceremony involving Starlink representatives still to be held. Cabinet had approved the operator's internet service provider licence on 18 February 2026, subject to conditions, and the company had incorporated as a local Seychelles entity and entered the final stage of licensing by May 2026.

Earth observation is a different matter: geospatial data reaches the public through one service, the lands ministry's WebGIS platform, which gives public search access to land parcels, survey beacons and planning layers, compiled periodically rather than live, with the authoritative survey records held separately by the Lands Department. Weather forecasting is the routine operational use on record: the Meteorological Authority's forecasters use EUMETSAT satellite products for nowcasting and the authority runs a WIS2.0 node for World Meteorological Organization data, though it has no weather radar and no formal data-sharing policy (2025).

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

The clearest American position inside Seychelles' state systems is a donor-funded one: the Electronic Case Management System launched for the legal affairs sector in June 2026 was developed with United States State Department funding, delivered through the UN Office on Drugs and Crime's Global Maritime Crime Programme and UNOPS. The delivery chain is the substance of it — the money is American, the build was run by two UN bodies, and the working platform now sits inside a Seychellois ministry.

The commercial footprint arrived separately and moved faster. Cabinet approved an ISP licence for Starlink in February 2026, the company incorporated locally and reached the final stage of licensing by May, and service began under a soft launch announced at State House on 21 July 2026, with the Vice-President and the Seychelles Communications Regulatory Authority presenting the regulatory framework together. An American satellite operator now sells internet directly to Seychellois consumers in its own name, as a licensed local company rather than through an existing carrier.

China activities

Huawei's position in Seychelles reaches past the network and into the classroom. The Ministry of Education and Cable & Wireless Seychelles put Huawei's SMART Education platform, running on the vendor's own devices and centrally managed, into secondary schools in August 2025 — the same operator that had launched the country's first 5G network with Huawei in July 2020.

The third thread is emergency communications: China's Hytera and Cable & Wireless Seychelles signed a memorandum of understanding at Mobile World Congress in March 2025 covering a redundant network intended to keep communications running during disasters. The Chinese footprint is vendor-shaped and concentrated: mobile network equipment, classroom hardware and a proposed disaster network, every one of them reaching the country through the same private operator.

EU activities

European engagement reaches Seychelles as trade law and as regulator contact rather than as projects. The ninth political dialogue of October 2022 recorded an agreement to explore cooperation on cybersecurity, disinformation, safer internet use and the protection of personal data, and in February 2026 the Information Commission's chief executive and Chief Information Commissioner met EUROJUST and EU Delegation representatives on cooperation and capacity building in data protection.

The binding half is newer. In June 2026 the Union and four eastern and southern African states including Seychelles concluded negotiations on an enhanced Economic Partnership Agreement carrying a binding prohibition of unjustified data-localisation requirements and a permanent ban on customs duties on electronic transmissions, and the 2026-2030 fisheries protocol published in the Official Journal on 11 August 2026 sets confidentiality and personal-data protection rules for the electronic vessel data the parties exchange. The one delivered system on the record came through trade too: the revenue commission's customs ePayment facility was delivered under the Economic Partnership Agreement — so the European footprint constrains what Seychelles may do with data more than it builds anything with it, and no European Union programme or European vendor held a named role in Seychelles' digital public infrastructure as at September 2026.

Gulf/UAE activities

The Gulf reaches Seychelles through two central banks and a classroom programme. In July 2024 the central banks of the United Arab Emirates and Seychelles signed two memoranda covering settlement in local currencies and the interlinking of instant-payment platforms, electronic switches and messaging systems, naming financial technology and central bank digital currency as cooperation areas. Two years on, nothing held records an interlinked switch, a live corridor or a digital-currency pilot between them.

The delivered engagement is educational: Seychelles launched a Digital School Initiative with the United Arab Emirates in 2025, a classroom-technology programme distinct from the education ministry's own management information systems. Around it sits infrastructure that is not digital at all: in May 2026 the Emirates reaffirmed commitments to four desalination plants, a sports complex and housing, and opened preliminary talks on direct oil procurement — no Gulf state held a role in Seychelles' core public registries as at September 2026, and its role in payments is an agreement rather than a rail.

India activities

Seychelles has agreed to adopt India's retail payment standard as a national instant-payments route. NPCI International and the Central Bank of Seychelles signed a memorandum of understanding during Prime Minister Modi's visit on 29 June 2026 to roll out the Unified Payments Interface, targeted for the end of that year, covering instant mobile and QR payments between bank accounts, along with regulatory preparation on standards, cybersecurity and interoperability. It is aimed at the India-source tourist market and at financial inclusion — the traffic that justifies the build is Indian visitors spending in Seychelles, and the domestic gain follows from rails laid for them. The dependency that comes with it is a standards one: the specification, and the body that governs it, are Indian, and the Central Bank's preparatory work is on interoperating with that system rather than on running one of its own.

Digital sovereignty

Seychelles is examining the contract behind its digital border in public: a presidential Commission of Inquiry into the Border Management Service Agreement with Travizory Border Security SA, whose system runs the immigration department's digital border control and the electronic travel authorisation for visitors, opened on 2 September 2026, and heard two former ministers describe the established international providers the government considered before Travizory (September 2026).

State data sits wherever each body puts it. Each ministry or agency houses its own data or places it with a cloud provider, and there is no government-wide hosting (2024). The rule that binds is on personal data: the Data Protection Act 2023 requires every processor's contract to let it move personal data to another country only on the controller's instruction. Cable & Wireless Seychelles offers its Tier IV centre as a way for government services to run on infrastructure inside the country rather than overseas (March 2026).

The state is taking some systems back from their builders. Cabinet confined PwC's continued work on the ASP Connect social-protection system in 2026 to stabilisation and knowledge transfer to government, and made the ICT department responsible for bringing it into full government ownership (March 2026), and the immigration department's 2024 digitalisation modules were built with the ICT department within its existing budget. The Central Bank operates the domestic transfer system SEFT itself. SeyID's authentication rests on WISeKey's OISTE public-key infrastructure. Whether the state holds the source code and operating skills for SeyID, or can exit its WISeKey contract, was not on record as at September 2026. The terms on which the Travizory agreement, the WISeKey partnership and the 2026 memorandum with NPCI International govern data jurisdiction, portability and exit had not been published as at September 2026.

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